



Introduction to Spring Boot

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- Spring is a very popular Java EE framework for building web and enterprise applications.
- Spring's dependency injection (DI) simplifies the development process by eliminating the need for manual object instantiation and configuration.
- Basically, Spring-based applications needs lot of configurations.
- Basic idea behind spring boot development is to make a spring do this configuration.
- Spring Boot is basically an extension of the Spring framework which eliminated the boilerplate configurations required for setting up a Spring application.

2. Advantages over spring framework

- Spring Boot works well with several servlet containers
- Spring initializr helps to quick setup the application.
- Decreased boilerplate code
- Embedded tomcat servers
- No XML configuration required
- WAR files are not required
- Spring boot starter parent
- Opinionated Defaults Configuration approach to reduce Developer effort
- A large community of helpful users

- Basically two approaches for creating a simple Spring Boot application
 - Spring Initializr: It is a web based tool which allows to generate spring boot application for given requirement which can be downloaded and imported in IDE like eclipse
 - Using eclipse plugin: From eclipse marketplace install spring boot plugin which helps in creating spring boot application
- Only spring starter parent dependency is sufficient for simple console based application
- Verify the beans that get created automatically. A lot of beans get created automatically because of automatic configuration

3. Developing simple MVC application

- For creating MVC application, add the dependency for spring-boot-starter-web.
- Add @ComponentScan annotation above main class based on package in which controller class resides
- Create controller class having business logic methods annotated with appropriate @RequestMapping annotation
- Specify view prefix and suffix in application.properties file
- Create the required views in the given location
- Start the Spring Boot MVC application, and it will be accessible by default on `http://localhost:8080/<mapping-url>`